

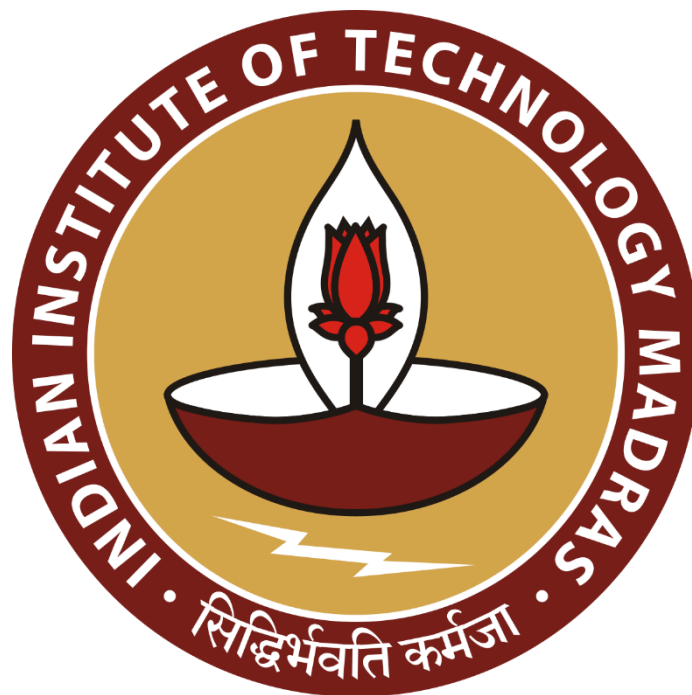
Enhancing Product Uptake in a Wellness-Focused Direct Selling Business Operating in an Emerging Market

A Final Report for the BDM capstone Project

Submitted by

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Contents

1	Executive Summary and Title	2
2	Detailed Explanation of Analysis Process / Method	2
2.1	Method for Survey and Hypothesis Testing	3
2.2	Method for Sales and Product Analysis	7
2.3	Qualitative Analysis	8
3	Results and Findings	8
3.1	Survey Demographics and Willingness Analysis	8
3.2	Barrier Analysis and Hypothesis Testing	9
3.3	Urban vs Rural Analysis	10
3.4	Motivators for Product Adoption	11
3.5	Product-Wise Sales Analysis	11
3.6	ABC Classification Table	12
3.7	Integrated Insights	13
4	Interpretation of Results and Recommendations	13
4.1	Core Inferences	13
4.2	Strategies to Improve Sales	14
4.3	Projected Impact	17
4.4	Limitations	18
5	Additional	18

1. Executive Summary

Kayal Wellness Center, located in Bodinayakanur, Theni, has been engaged in the distribution of Herbalife nutrition products since May 2025. Despite offering a wide variety of nutritional supplements, the business faces challenges in expanding customer intake and boosting sales. To investigate these challenges, a structured analysis was undertaken by collecting both customer survey data and product sales records.

The survey, conducted during July–August 2025, received 53 valid responses through a Google Form. The questionnaire captured customer demographics, prior awareness of Herbalife, willingness to adopt nutrition products, and perceived barriers such as price, trust, and availability of potential customers. In parallel, four months of sales data (May–August 2025) were recorded from the founder’s diary and converted into Excel format. This dataset contained product names, units sold, and sales frequency, enabling detailed product-level analysis.

Descriptive statistics revealed that only 23% of respondents considered price as a major concern, whereas awareness and trust issues were cited by over 50%. A Z-test further validated that price is not the primary sales barrier. Age-segment analysis showed that the 21–40 age group demonstrated the highest willingness to purchase, indicating a target demographic for future growth. Analysis of urban vs rural respondents showed no significant difference in willingness to spend, suggesting that location is not a major factor influencing adoption, and that common strategies can be applied across both groups. On the product side, an ABC analysis highlighted that three key products—Formula-1, Shake Mate, and Afresh—account for nearly 80% of sales, aligning with the Pareto principle.

The findings suggest that strategic focus on awareness campaigns, trust-building initiatives, and prioritizing “A-category” products can significantly enhance customer engagement and sales performance at Kayal Wellness Center.

2. Detailed Explanation of Analysis Process / Method

The analysis for this project was conducted using a combination of **primary survey data**, collected using Google forms from potential customers and **sales transaction data** collected from Kayal Wellness Center, Bodinayakanur. The objective was to systematically identify the barriers affecting customer conversion, assess product performance, and derive actionable business insights. Multiple analytical methods, including descriptive statistics, hypothesis testing, and ABC–Pareto analysis, were applied to extract meaningful patterns from the data. The overall methodology is divided into three major components: survey analysis, sales data analysis, and qualitative insights.

2.1 Method for Survey and Hypothesis Testing

To understand customer perceptions and purchase behavior, a **Google Form survey** was conducted among potential customers between July and August 2025. The survey targeted both existing visitors to the wellness center and general public respondents to gain broader insights, this was circulated using whatsapp and emails. A total of **53 valid responses** were collected. The questionnaire focused on following major areas:

Feature Name	Description	Data Type
Age	Age group of respondent	Categorical
Gender	Gender of respondent	Categorical
Occupation	Work/Study status	Categorical
Education	Level of education	Categorical
Location	Urban or Rural	Categorical
Awareness of Herbalife	Whether respondent has heard of Herbalife	Binary (Yes/No)
Barriers to Adoption	Reasons for not purchasing (price, trust, remedies)	Categorical
Willingness to Spend	Willingness to pay ₹1000+ per month	Ordinal

Table 1 Description of Survey data

The collected data was exported as an Excel file and cleaned using Google Sheets. Pivot tables were created to analyze demographic trends such as **age group vs. willingness to spend**, **location vs. willingness**, and **price perception frequencies**. Visualization techniques such as **stacked bar charts**, **simple bar graphs**, and **frequency distributions** were employed to make the trends easier to interpret. Figure 1 shows a snapshot of the survey data table.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
	Form_Responses						
1	Timestamp	Age:	Gender:	Occupation:	If Other occupation, please mention what it is	Education	Do you live in Urban or Rural area?
6	7/18/2025 12:29:35	21-30	Male	Working professional		Graduate	Urban
7	7/18/2025 12:39:14	Under 20	Male	Student		Graduate	Urban
8	7/18/2025 12:45:08	Under 20	Male	Student		School	Urban
9	7/18/2025 12:48:49	31-40	Female	Homemaker		Graduate	Urban
10	7/18/2025 12:48:50	21-30	Female	Working professional		Graduate	Urban
11	7/18/2025 12:50:50	21-30	Female	Student		Graduate	Urban
12	7/18/2025 12:55:53	41-50	Female	Homemaker		Graduate	Urban
13	7/18/2025 13:12:55	31-40	Female	Homemaker		Graduate	Urban
14	7/18/2025 13:12:59	Under 20	Female	Student		School	Urban

Figure 1 – Snapshot of survey response data table

Understanding Public Awareness & Willingness to Adopt Nutrition Products like Herbalife

Hi! I'm Jeevaharini, currently working on my **Capstone Project** as part of my diploma, and I've chosen to study how people feel about wellness and nutrition products – especially brands like **Herbalife**.

As part of my research, I'm working closely with a small **Herbalife wellness center**. I'm trying to understand what influences people's decisions on product purchase – like product price, awareness, trust, or lifestyle habits.

This short survey is for **general public awareness** – whether or not you've used Herbalife. It will help me get a broader perspective on how people view wellness products and what could make them more appealing.

It takes just **2–3 minutes** to fill, and all your answers are anonymous and only used for my project. Thank you so much for helping me out!

Age:

☐ Under 20

☐ 21-30

☐ 31-40

☐ 41-50

☐ 51+

Gender:

☐ Male

☐ Female

Figure 2 – Snapshot of survey form

To statistically validate observed patterns, **z-tests for proportions** were conducted:

- **One-proportion Z-test** was applied to test the hypothesis that *price is the major barrier* to product adoption.
 - Null Hypothesis (H_0): 50% or more respondents view price as the major barrier.

- Alternative Hypothesis (H_1): Less than 50% respondents view price as the major barrier.
- Only 22.6% of respondents selected price as a barrier. The calculated z-score was -3.98 with a p-value of 6.8×10^{-5} , leading to rejection of H_0 .
- This proved that **price is not the primary reason for low conversion**. Instead, factors like trust and product awareness play a larger role.

Step	Description	Value
Step A — get counts	Number who selected “Too expensive”	12
	Number of responses that answered the barriers question	53
	p_hat	0.2264150943
Step B — test vs 0.50	p0	0.5
	SE	0.06868028197
	z	-3.983456355
	Two-tailed p-value	0.000067920150

Table 2 One-proportion Z-test for Price as a Barrier

- **Two-proportion Z-test** was used to compare willingness to spend between urban and rural respondents. The difference in willingness between urban (21.3%) and rural (16.7%) groups was statistically insignificant ($p \approx 0.79$). This indicated that **geographic location is not a major differentiator** in purchase behavior.

Section	Details
Goal	Are Urban respondents more likely to say “Yes” to ₹1000+ than Rural?

Pooled Proportion (p_{pool})	0.208
Standard Error (SE)	0.176
Z-score	0.262
p-value	0.793
Hypotheses	H ₀ : Urban = Rural (no difference) H ₁ : Urban > Rural
Results	Urban Yes rate ≈ 21.3% Rural Yes rate ≈ 16.7% Difference = 4.6%
Statistical Decision	p = 0.793 >> 0.05 → Fail to reject H ₀
Conclusion	No statistically significant difference between Urban and Rural willingness to spend ₹1000+.

Table 3 Two-proportion Z-test for Location as a Barrier

The survey data was analyzed entirely in **Google Sheets**, using built-in functions for pivot tables and statistical calculations. This approach provided quantitative evidence for decision-making and helped pinpoint awareness and trust gaps more accurately than anecdotal assumptions.

2.2 Method for Sales and Product Analysis

The second part of the analysis involved **product-wise sales data** collected from the center's physical diary between May and August 2025. The distributor manually records the daily number of units sold for each product, along with price details. This data was digitized into Excel for ease of analysis. The goal was to identify the products contributing the most to sales and segment them for better inventory and marketing management.

Product	May	June	July	August	Total Sales	Total sales %	Cumulative	Price	Revenue
Formula-1	11	11	1	5	28	36.84%	36.84%	2449	68572
Shake matte	6	6	3	3	18	23.68%	60.53%	733	13194
Afresh	5	5	5	2	17	22.37%	82.89%	913	15521
Beta Heart	1	0	0	2	3	3.95%	86.84%	2520	7560
Nitework	1	1	0	0	2	2.63%	89.47%	2010	4020
Aloe concentrate	1	1	0	0	2	2.63%	92.11%	3030	6060
Multivitamin	0	2	0	0	2	2.63%	94.74%	2252	4504
Protein powder	0	1	0	1	2	2.63%	97.37%	1455	2910
simply probiotic	1	0	0	0	1	1.32%	98.68%	2482	2482
Cell-u-loss	0	1	0	0	1	1.32%	100.00%	1916	1916

Figure 3 – Sales Data from May- August 2025

For each product, the total units sold and revenue contributions were calculated. Using these values, an **ABC analysis** was performed to categorize products based on their cumulative contribution to total sales:

- **Category A:** Top ~80% of sales value — high priority products.
- **Category B:** Next ~15% — medium priority.
- **Category C:** Remaining low-selling products.

The **Pareto principle (80/20 rule)** was applied to verify that a small number of products contribute to the majority of revenue. Cumulative sales percentages were calculated using the formula:

$$\text{Cumulative Percentage} = \frac{\text{Cumulative Sales Value}}{\text{Total Sales Value}} \times 100$$

A Pareto chart was then created by plotting products in descending order of sales, combined with a cumulative percentage line. The analysis showed that **three products—Formula-1, Shake Mate, and Afresh—together accounted for more than 80% of total sales**. These were classified as Category A products. B and C category products contributed marginally and were mainly supplementary items.

This method helped in identifying **hero products** that should be prioritized for promotions, trial offers, and stock management. Category B products are potential candidates for bundling strategies, while Category C products should be stocked selectively to avoid overstocking.

2.3 Qualitative Analysis

In addition to quantitative data, **qualitative insights** were collected through discussions with one of the center's owner, Sumathi. The business was started in May 2025 and operates in a semi-urban region. It was observed that many walk-in visitors come for free body analysis sessions but hesitate to commit to purchases. Sales recording is done manually in a diary, and most customer communication happens informally through word-of-mouth.

These qualitative observations provided crucial context to interpret the survey and sales data findings. For example, low repeat visits were closely linked to trust issues rather than affordability. Similarly, dependency on offline word-of-mouth limited the center's ability to build sustained customer relationships.

3. Results and Findings

The analysis of both survey and sales data provided crucial insights into the factors influencing customer conversion and product performance at Kayal Wellness Center. This section presents the key findings supported by charts, tables, and statistical tests, structured into two major parts: survey-based customer insights and sales/product analysis. Each figure is followed by a detailed explanation to ensure clarity and alignment with business objectives.

3.1 Survey Demographics and Willingness Analysis

Figure 4 shows the distribution of survey respondents across different age groups and their willingness to spend ₹1000 or more per month on wellness products. The 21–30 age group constitutes the largest proportion of respondents and shows a high percentage of “Maybe” responses, indicating potential interest but uncertainty in committing to purchases. The under-20 age group is smaller in size but also shows a mix of “Maybe” and “Yes” responses, suggesting openness to wellness products if approached effectively. In contrast, the 41–50 age group has the highest percentage of “No” responses, indicating lower likelihood of adoption in this segment. Interestingly, the 51+ age group shows a relatively balanced mix of “Yes” and “Maybe” responses, suggesting that with targeted awareness and trust-building efforts, this demographic could also be converted into a steady customer base.

This finding highlights that the 21–30 demographic represents the most promising target group for conversion, while the 51+ group provides a secondary opportunity if messaging emphasizes long-term health benefits and credibility of products.

Age wise Willingness to spend on wellness products

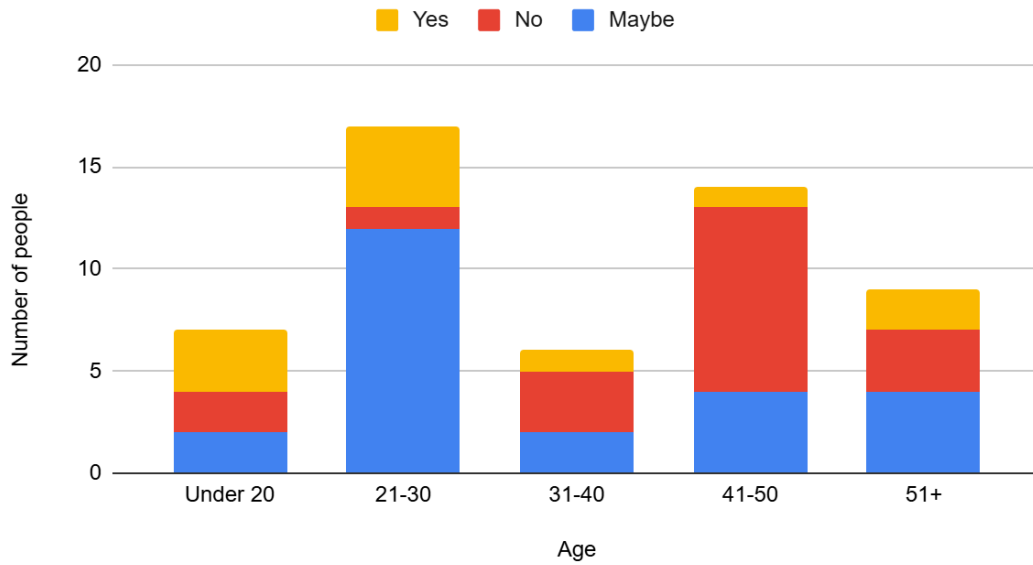


Figure 4: Stacked bar chart – Age vs Willingness to Spend

3.2 Barrier Analysis and Hypothesis Testing

Figure 5 presents the number of respondents who listed price (“Too expensive”) as a reason for not buying Herbalife products. Of the 53 respondents who answered the barrier question, only **12 (22.6%)** identified price as a main concern; **41 (77.4%)** did not. A one-proportion z-test against $p_0 = 0.5$ produced $z = -3.98$ and $p \approx 6.8 \times 10^{-5}$, allowing rejection of the null hypothesis at the 1% level. Thus, although price plays some role, it is **not the primary** impediment to purchase. Survey responses more often referenced **awareness, trust and preference for natural remedies**, indicating that Kayal Wellness Center should emphasise trust-building and educational tactics (testimonials, free trials, clear product benefit communication) to convert hesitant customers.

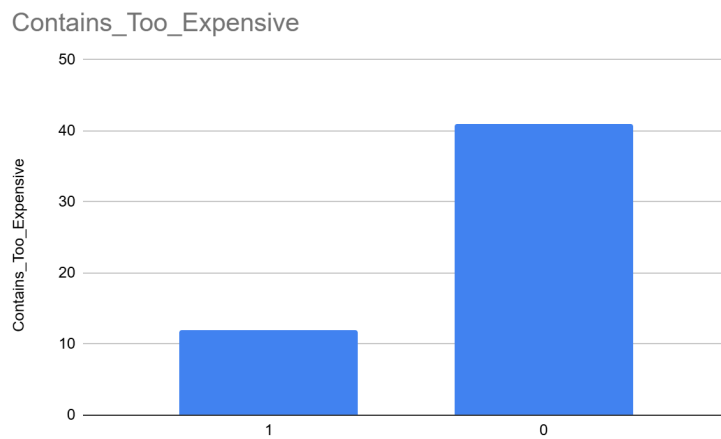


Figure 5: Count of respondents citing price as a barrier

3.3 Urban vs Rural Analysis

Figure 6 compares willingness to spend between urban and rural respondents. Urban respondents show a slightly higher willingness (21.3%) compared to rural respondents (16.7%). However, a **two-proportion Z-test** indicated that this difference is statistically insignificant ($p \approx 0.79$).

This suggests that **location is not a major differentiating factor** in purchase willingness. The primary issues affecting both groups are similar—awareness, trust, and perceived value of the products—rather than geographic or socioeconomic differences. This insight allows the business to design **uniform marketing strategies** applicable to both urban and rural segments, instead of fragmenting campaigns by geography.

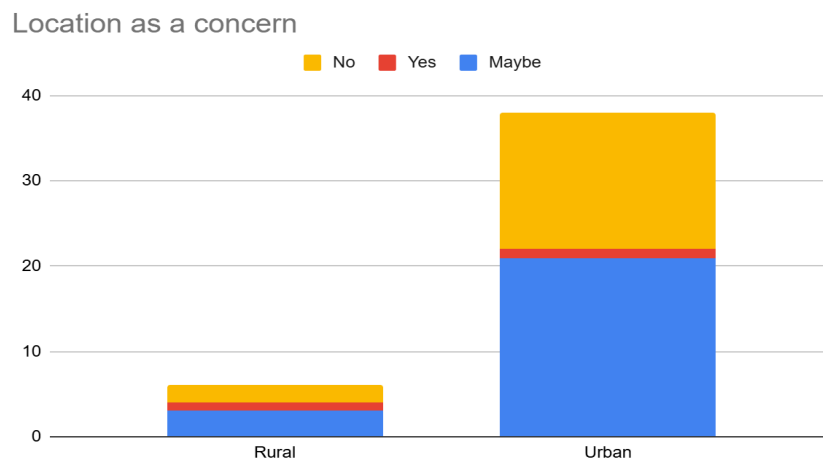


Figure 6: Bar chart – Urban vs Rural Willingness

3.4 Motivators for Product Adoption

Figure 7 shows the distribution of motivators that could make respondents more likely to try Herbalife products. **Free trials or samples** and **testimonials from real people** emerged as the top motivators, followed by **smaller affordable packs** and **better explanation of product benefits**. Doctor recommendations and visible results in others were also reported by some participants.

This finding aligns with the earlier barrier analysis, emphasizing that **reducing uncertainty and building trust** are the most effective levers for increasing adoption. Free trials help overcome hesitation among “Maybe” respondents, while testimonials and education provide social proof and clarity on product value.

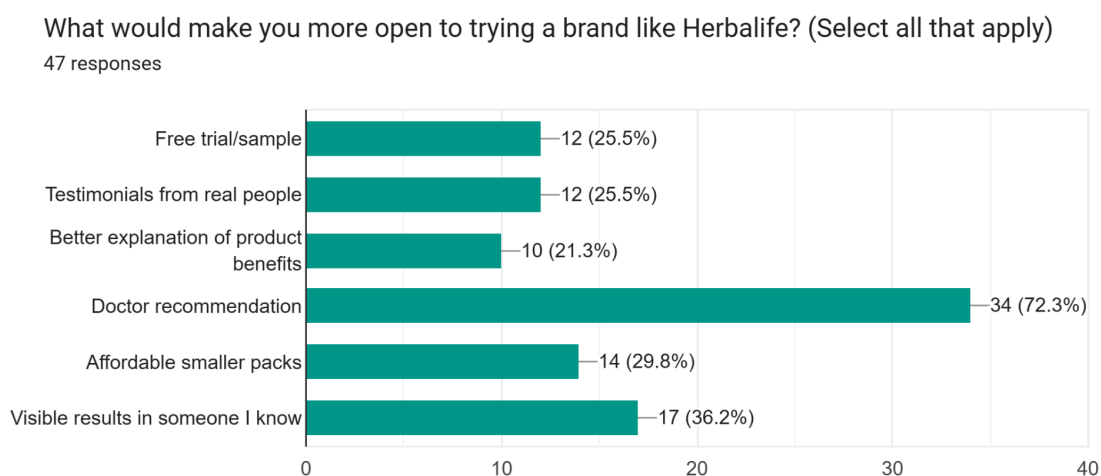


Figure 7: Bar chart – Motivators for Adoption

3.5 Product-Wise Sales Analysis

Figure 8 presents the total units sold for each product over the January–February 2025 period. Sales are heavily concentrated in three products: **Formula-1**, **Shake Mate**, and **Afresh**, which together contribute to more than 80% of the total units sold. This pattern was confirmed through ABC analysis and Pareto charting.

These products were classified as **Category A** in the ABC analysis, representing high-priority items for promotion and inventory management. Category B includes medium-performing products that can be effectively bundled with Category A items. Category C contains low-selling products that should be stocked in limited quantities to avoid inventory buildup.

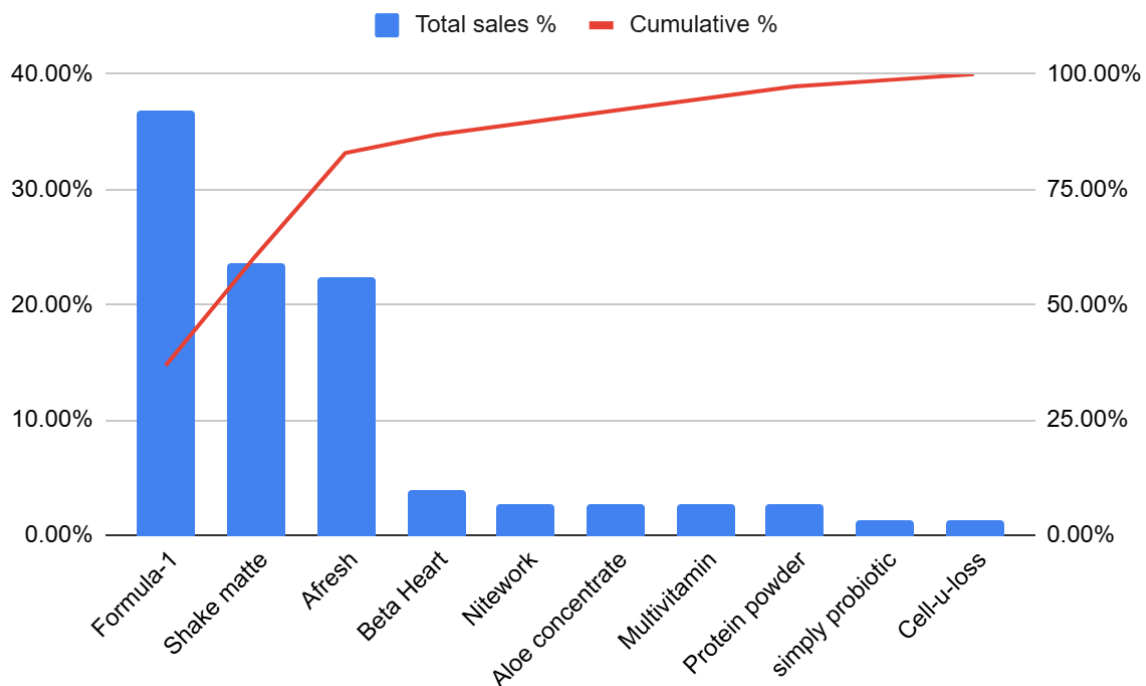


Figure 8: Pareto Chart – Product-wise Sales Contribution

3.6 ABC Classification Table

Table 4 summarizes the results of the ABC classification. Category A products (Formula-1, Shake Mate, Afresh) account for the majority of revenue and should be the primary focus of promotional campaigns and customer acquisition strategies. Category B products have moderate potential and can support bundling strategies, while Category C products are suitable only for selective stocking or niche promotions.

Category	Product Names	Contribution Sales (%)	Strategy Recommendation
A	Formula-1, Shake Mate, Afresh	~81%	Prioritize promotion, sampling, ensure availability
B	Aloe Concentrate, Multivitamin	~12%	Bundle with A products, cross-sell

C	Others	~7%	Limited stock, niche targeting
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Table 4: ABC Classification Summary

3.7 Integrated Insights

By combining the findings from the survey and sales analyses, a clear strategy emerges for Kayal Wellness Center. The “Maybe” respondents in the 21–30 age group and 51+ age group represent the most convertible customer segment. Their hesitation is driven by trust and awareness gaps, not price sensitivity. Meanwhile, **Formula-1, Shake Mate, and Afresh** are the center’s strongest products and should be used as **hero products** for promotions, free trials, and testimonials.

This integrated understanding allows the center to align its marketing and inventory efforts effectively: target the right demographic with the right products and address the correct barriers.

4. Interpretation of Results and Recommendations

The combined analysis of survey responses and sales data provided **evidence-based insights** into the current bottlenecks at *Kayal Wellness Center* and suggested practical ways to improve performance.

4.1 Core Inferences

1. The **conversion barrier analysis**, using a one-proportion *z-test* ($z = -3.98$, $p = 6.8 \times 10^{-5}$), demonstrated that **price is not the dominant obstacle** for potential customers. Instead, the primary hurdles lie in **low awareness, lack of trust in the brand, and uncertainty about the benefits of the products**. These findings suggest that education-focused marketing and testimonial-driven campaigns would be more effective than price discounts in encouraging trial and adoption.
2. The **target-segment analysis** highlighted that the **21–30 age group** constituted the largest share of respondents and showed the highest proportion of “Maybe” responses. This group represents the most promising segment for conversion if they are provided with better product information and **low-risk entry options**, such as free trials or smaller pack sizes. Additionally, the **51+ age group**, though smaller in size, also demonstrated a relatively balanced mix of “Yes” and “Maybe” responses. This suggests that with strategies focusing on **trust, credibility, and long-term health benefits**, this older demographic could serve as a valuable secondary target segment for the business.

3. From the **ABC analysis of product sales**, it was found that **Formula-1, Afresh, and Shake Mate (Category-A products)** together contribute approximately **81 % of the total revenue**. These products have strong existing demand and should remain the **hero products** for focused marketing campaigns, introductory sampling, and promotional offers.
4. The **geographical analysis** indicated that there is **no significant difference in willingness to purchase between urban and rural respondents** ($p \approx 0.79$). This insight suggests that a **single, consistent marketing approach** can be effectively applied across locations without the need for region-specific strategies.

4.2 Strategies to Improve Sales

The following strategies, based on the insights gathered from survey and sales data analysis, are recommended to improve customer conversion and boost sales at Kayal Wellness Center. The table below outlines the **focus areas, suggested actions**, and their **expected effects on sales**. The **projections** are based on survey results and current sales data, with assumptions about market conditions remaining stable.

4.2.1 Awareness and Trust

One of the most critical barriers identified in the survey was the lack of awareness and trust in Herbalife products. Many respondents reported uncertainty about the effectiveness of wellness products, or showed hesitation due to limited knowledge of the benefits. To address this, the center can organize **monthly workshops and live demonstrations**, where potential customers are educated on product benefits through practical sessions. These workshops should focus on the science behind wellness nutrition, success stories of regular users, and specific use cases of Herbalife products for different lifestyle needs.

In addition, the introduction of **small starter packs or free trial sachets** can significantly reduce the entry barrier. Hesitant customers who are unwilling to commit to higher spending will have the opportunity to experience the products first-hand, thereby building confidence without the financial burden of a large purchase. Further, by showcasing **authentic customer testimonials**, both on social media and within the physical wellness center, the brand can reinforce credibility and build stronger connections with the community.

Through these combined awareness-building and trust-enhancing measures, the center can target the sizable “Maybe” segment—approximately 45% of survey respondents—converting them into active customers. Over a 3–6 month period, it is estimated that conversion rates could increase by 20–25%, laying the foundation for long-term customer loyalty and brand reputation.

4.2.2 Hero-Product Promotion

The sales analysis conducted using ABC and Pareto methods revealed that three products—Formula-1, Afresh, and Shake Mate—collectively contribute to nearly 81% of total sales. This indicates that these items serve as **hero products**, driving both customer acquisition and revenue. Leveraging their popularity, the wellness center should position these products as **entry points** for new customers. By focusing promotional campaigns on these products, customers are more likely to be attracted to proven and widely used items, thereby enhancing conversion rates.

A second strategy involves **bundling hero products with B-category products**. For instance, Formula-1 could be paired with Aloe Concentrate or Multivitamin supplements, creating attractive value packs. This not only ensures customers are introduced to a wider product range but also increases the average order value. Promotional bundles can be offered at slight discounts, encouraging customers to try more while maintaining profitability.

Implementing such a strategy could raise sales of A-category products by 15–20%, which in turn may boost total monthly revenue by 12–15%. Most importantly, the promotion of these hero products reinforces customer trust, since they are already well-accepted and highly demanded, making them ideal to anchor all sales campaigns.

4.2.3 Digital Data Recording

At present, the wellness center relies on handwritten diaries to record sales and product details. While this method reflects discipline in tracking, it lacks the **efficiency, scalability, and accuracy** needed for data-driven decision making. Transitioning to a **digital system**, such as an Excel-based tracker or a simple Point-of-Sale (POS) solution, would allow the business to monitor sales trends in real-time and manage inventory more effectively.

By recording **product-wise sales and customer details weekly**, the owner will be able to identify which products are moving fast, which require stronger promotion, and when to reorder stocks. Improved tracking also reduces the risk of stockouts, ensuring that popular items such as Formula-1 are always available to meet customer demand. Furthermore, digital records make it easier to analyze monthly and seasonal sales trends, enabling smarter promotional offers at the right time.

Over the long run, better data management will translate into **optimized inventory costs, improved repeat purchases, and a more responsive business model**. The move from diary-based manual entries to digital tools represents a critical step in professionalizing operations and ensuring sustainable growth.

4.2.4 Customer Engagement

The survey analysis also revealed that the **21–30 age group** represents the most promising demographic for customer conversion. This group not only constituted the largest segment

of respondents but also showed the highest percentage of “Maybe” responses. To tap into this opportunity, the wellness center should design marketing campaigns specifically tailored for young adults. Initiatives such as **referral bonuses** can encourage existing customers to bring in peers, leveraging the strong influence of word-of-mouth within this age group.

Additionally, offering **first-month discounts for new users** can help lower the financial barrier of trial, making it easier for hesitant customers to make an initial purchase. Over time, such discounts can lead to repeat buying once customers recognize product benefits. For younger customers, digital engagement is equally important. Social media campaigns, Instagram testimonials, and WhatsApp-based reminders can be integrated into the customer engagement strategy to keep the brand top of mind.

These initiatives, if executed consistently, could improve **customer retention by 5–10% over the next three months**, while also strengthening brand loyalty and enhancing lifetime customer value. Moreover, secondary opportunities exist in the **51+ age group**, which displayed a mix of “Yes” and “Maybe” responses. Tailored strategies emphasizing long-term health benefits, trust, and credibility can also convert this group into a stable customer base.

Focus Area	Suggested Action	Expected Effect on Sales
Awareness & Trust	• Conduct monthly local workshops and demonstrations. • Provide small starter packs or free trial sachets. • Share local customer testimonials on social media and in-center.	Can lift conversion among the “Maybe” group by 20–25 % over 3–6 months.
Hero-Product Promotion	• Promote Formula-1, Afresh & Shake Mate as entry products. • Bundle B-category products with them.	May increase sales of A-products by 15–20 %, boosting total revenue by ≈ 12–15 %.

Digital Data Recording	• Shift from handwritten diary to simple POS / Excel logging. • Track weekly product-wise sales and customer details.	Enables better inventory control and timely offers, helping reduce stockouts and improve repeat sales.
Customer Engagement	• Focus campaigns on the 21–30 age group. • Offer referral bonuses and first-month discounts for new users.	Higher retention; projected 5–10 % increase in repeat purchases in 3 months.

Table 4: Summary of strategies to improve sales

4.3 Projected Impact

If the recommended measures are implemented, a significant improvement in customer acquisition and revenue generation can be expected. Converting even **25 % of the “Maybe” respondents**—which represents about **11 % of the total sample**—into paying customers could increase the **overall customer base by approximately 40–50 %**. This highlights the substantial untapped potential among undecided customers who can be persuaded through awareness programs, free trials, and testimonials.

In addition, by **focusing on A-class products** such as Formula-1, Afresh, and Shake Mate, which already dominate current sales, the center can leverage its strongest offerings to achieve greater efficiency. Concentrating promotional efforts and sampling on these products is projected to **increase monthly revenue by about 12–15 %** without requiring any significant increase in marketing expenditure.

Furthermore, implementing **improved record-keeping practices**, such as replacing handwritten logs with simple digital tools, will enhance the center’s ability to monitor sales performance in real time. This will enable continuous optimization of marketing strategies and better targeting of customer segments, ensuring sustained growth in the long term.

4.4 Limitations

The projections presented in this report are subject to certain limitations. The **survey sample size of 53 respondents** restricts the precision of growth estimates and may not fully capture the diversity of the potential market. Additionally, the **sales data analyzed covers only a four-month period**, which limits the ability to identify seasonal trends or long-term demand fluctuations.

These projections should therefore be considered **indicative rather than definitive**. They assume that market conditions, customer behavior, and competition remain stable during the projection period. Any significant changes in these external factors could alter the actual outcomes of the proposed strategies.

5. Additional

Project Drive:  Bdm project